AI ACADEMY · LEVEL 2 · GRADE 7 · WEEK 16 · TEACHER GUIDE

Overfitting Intuition

Learn to understand, design, build, test and explain AI systems responsibly.

Project: Transparent Book Recommender

THE CONNECTED WEEK

Teach model choice as an evidence-based development decision.

Provide raw validation predictions, distinguish the two comparisons and reserve the new tie case for assessment.

Keep one habit: Require the decision rule and remaining uncertainty beside every selected model.

MAIN LESSON · SECTION 1

Prepare this connected week

> Use one main plan and keep practice separate from the independent first attempt.

Learning goal and precision

Primary target: Compare **training** and validation **evidence** for model **capacity**

Teach two 45-minute sessions. This week focuses on **overfitting** and model **capacity**. Model the worked example first, collect the new W 4 case independently before feedback, and use the fresh retry to check transfer.

Award credit for traceable reasoning and bounded claims, including justified uncertainty.

By the end, I can use development performance rather than **training** fit alone to choose model **complexity**.

What to prepare

- Use the supplied scenario, student illustrations and blank paper. For numeric work, offer counters or a calculator after learners show the setup. Fictional records are supplied; personal data and paid accounts are unnecessary.
- Case exposure check: this source example appears in ai-2/16, ai-4/27, ai-4/30. Reuse a familiar case for recall or modelling; verify that the case used to assess transfer has not already received feedback.
- Printed student lesson and workbook
- Paper, pencils and a calculator for fractions
- The fictional examples and a blank **evidence** table
- Saved classroom project records for critique; no personal student dataset required

Main teaching plan

Session · Sequence and minutes · Resources

> **Session:** Session 1 · Understand · 45 min
>
> **Sequence and minutes:** 0–7: recall and prerequisite; 7–15: inspect the concrete case and predict; 15–30: teacher models the worked trace; 30–40: learners explain a step using the text and visual; 40–45: check the core idea.
>
> **Resources:** Use Your mission, Notice the evidence, See how it works, Compare the cases, Words that unlock the idea and Follow a worked example; record the brief recall in the workbook.

> **Session:** Session 2 · Practise · 45 min

> **Sequence and minutes:** 0–5: retrieve the procedure; 5–15: W2 completion practice; 15–23: explain and check with a partner; 23–30: each learner answers the misconception check; 30–40: targeted reteaching or a harder variation; 40–45: prepare the investigation.
>
> **Resources:** Use Find and repair a mistake, Practise together, Run the investigation and Build your understanding; use the matching workbook W2 and misconception check.

> **Session:** Session 3 · Investigate and transfer · 45 min
>
> **Sequence and minutes:** 0–5: retrieve the decision rule; 5–20: investigate or trace; 20–30: start the independent case; 30–38: connect the project; 38–43: act on feedback; 43–45: plan the return check.
>
> **Resources:** Use Run the investigation, Connect your project, Show what you know, Study a complete case and Try a new case independently. Allow extra time for the full task set. Use a coding lab only when this week actually provides one; Your lesson route is the planning section.

This is a starting allocation of 135 minutes, not a validated duration. Preserve all named topics. Schedule extra time for connected examples, the full investigation, independent cases and project building.

Repeated copies of a case share one recorded attempt; they are not new **evidence**.

Opening retrieval and readiness

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Choose Informative Questions. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Look for: Fit a root question and leaf **prediction**s from **training** examples

Reference example, not the only acceptable wording: The root asks near, with branches 0 and 1. Leaves predict clear for 0 and blocked for 1. Depth is one.

Training labels determined both leaf majorities and the error comparison that selected near rather than tall.

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Types of Classification Error. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Look for: Build a labelled confusion matrix from matched reference and **prediction** pairs

Reference example, not the only acceptable wording: Reference clear/predicted clear contains V1,V2: 2. Clear/blocked contains V3: 1. Blocked/clear contains V4,V5: 2. Blocked/blocked contains V6,V7,V8: 3. Matrix [[2,1],[2,3]].

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Human Classifier Simulation. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Look for: Construct a classifier with a stated **input** format, selected rule and recorded **output**

Reference example, not the only acceptable wording: Require a present height, unit cm, a whole number and range 1 through 10 inclusive.

For example, 7 cm is accepted; blank is missing, 60 mm has the wrong unit and 11 cm is outside the range. Fractional values such as 4.5 cm also fail.

The contract defines accepted **input**s; it does not list only the **fitting** records or establish **prediction** correctness.

No; it may fit peculiarities of the **training** sample.

▼ Earlier wording, alternatives and picture transcripts

Teach the learning cycle

Retrieval answer guidance

Choose Informative Questions

Types of Classification Error

Human Classifier Simulation

Use the student module and workbook section with this exact week title. The worked case, independent question and answers below form one aligned lesson sequence.

What the learner must demonstrate

Rule A memorises eight **training** IDs and gets 8/8 **training**, 2/8 validation. Rule B uses genre and gets 6/8 **training**, 6/8 validation. Which is preferable on this **evidence**, and what test remains?

Concept to explain

A rule that memorizes examples may fail on new cases.

Term	Meaning
overfitting	Adapting too closely to development examples so performance does not transfer well to new relevant cases.
generalize	Perform usefully on new relevant cases beyond those used to develop a system.
complexity	The amount of structure, work or resources a method requires, measured in a stated way.
exception	A condition that requires handling outside the usual path.

Prepare the class

This compact option is not the full-week schedule. Use the main teaching cycle and allow extra sessions for the investigation, independent work and project.

Allow 80 minutes: recall 8; explanation 12; worked demonstration 15; guided practice 20; independent assessment 15; project and reflection 10. Extend the lab into a second session when needed.

Preparation for the connected explanation

Readiness answer

End goal for the pictorial case

This added worked case illustrates the week's main idea. Retain all original and connected topics; schedule its practice within the teaching cycle.

MAIN LESSON · SECTION 2

Teach the validation choice with explicit units and records

> Separate the two worked comparisons and preserve final-test independence.

State model capacity and the fictional-data scope

A more flexible model can represent complicated relationships and accidental details. **Capacity** can help when there is enough relevant **evidence**, but perfect **training** performance is not the goal.

Compare **training** and validation using the same metric while checking leakage and representativeness.

Use fictional classroom data throughout this investigation. Keep the task, units, reference labels and data split visible as you reason.

Earlier weeks supplied the model-building **process**; this week examines **overfitting** and model **capacity**.

Define MAE and the lowest-validation rule

MAE means mean absolute error: find the size of each prediction mistake without its plus or minus sign, then average those sizes. Lower MAE means smaller average mistakes in the stated units. On the same regression split, a constant has **training** MAE 5 and validation 6, a line has **training** 2 and validation 3, and a highly flexible curve has **training** 0 and validation 8. Under smallest validation MAE, choose the line.

The curve has the lowest **training** loss but the worst validation result.

Read the opening comparison

Candidate	Training MAE (pages)	Validation MAE (pages)
Constant	5	6
Line	2	3
Flexible curve	0	8

Provide the raw validation audit records

Validation ID · Reference pages · Constant prediction · Line prediction · Flexible prediction

> **Validation ID:** V1
> **Reference pages:** 10
> **Constant prediction:** 22
> **Line prediction:** 13
> **Flexible prediction:** 18

> **Validation ID:** V2
> **Reference pages:** 14
> **Constant prediction:** 22
> **Line prediction:** 17
> **Flexible prediction:** 22

> **Validation ID:** V3
> **Reference pages:** 18
> **Constant prediction:** 22
> **Line prediction:** 21
> **Flexible prediction:** 26

> **Validation ID:** V4
> **Reference pages:** 22
> **Constant prediction:** 22
> **Line prediction:** 25
> **Flexible prediction:** 30

Collect the gap-only explanation

Does a training-validation gap alone prove overfitting? Explain the steps or evidence behind your response.

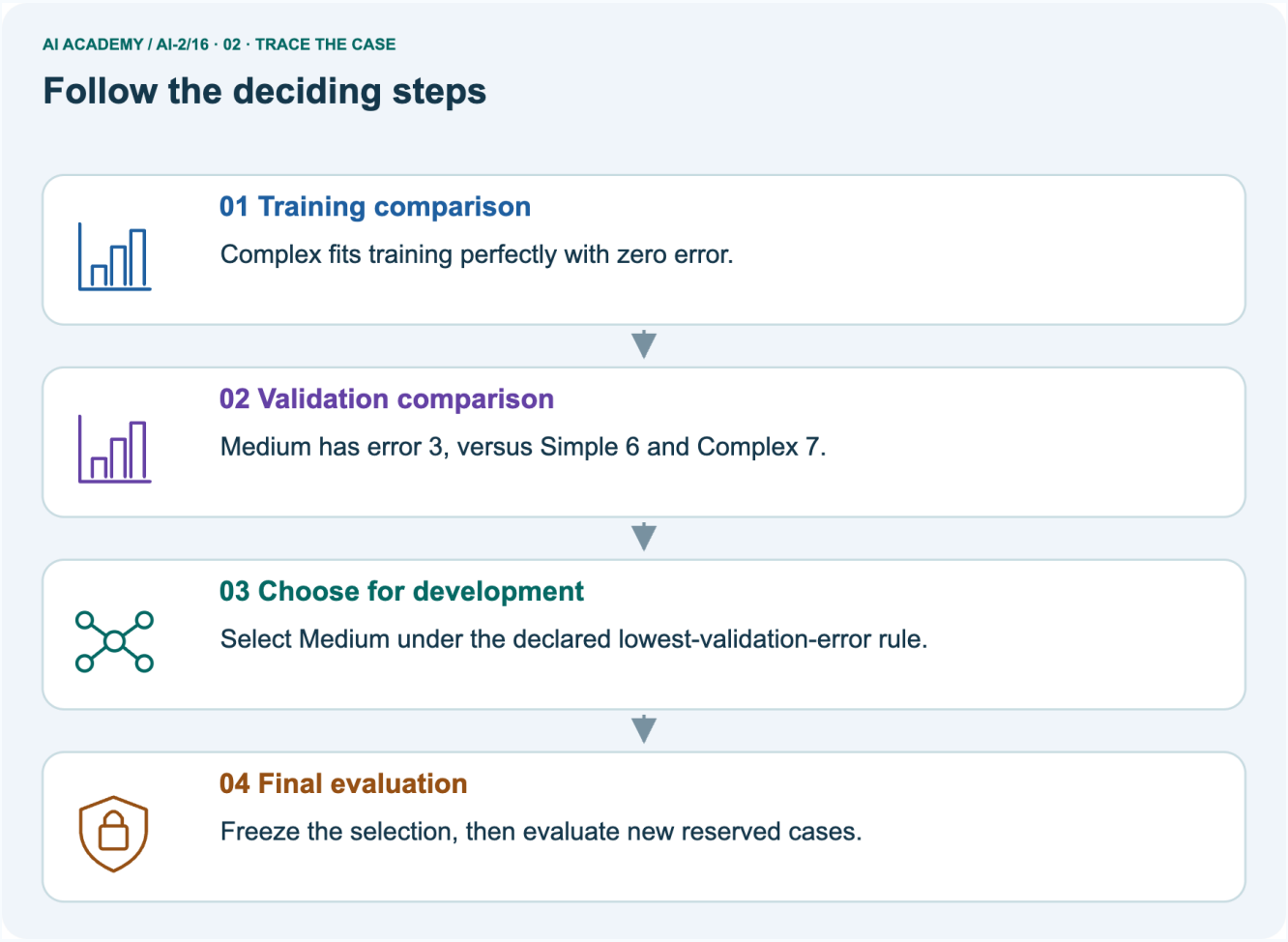
Introduce the separate pictured comparison

A fictional project compares three book-length **prediction** models on the same development sets.

Mean absolute errors in pages: Simple **training** 5, validation 6; Medium **training** 2, validation 3; Complex **training** 0, validation 7.

Select lowest validation error; untouched final tests are not used for selection.

Trace selection and its limits



Follow the labelled picture with the matching explanation. Open the vector diagram

A flexible model can fit quirks of its **training** set without predicting new examples well. Here Complex's **training** success occurs alongside the worst validation error.

The numbers are invented comparisons, not a claim that **complexity** always hurts. Choosing Medium uses development **evidence**; its validation score must not be advertised as an untouched final-test result.

A single small validation set may be noisy; selection **evidence** does not prove future population performance.

Interpret a better flexible-model development score

Change: Complex's validation error becomes 2 on a newly documented, fair development comparison.

Prediction: The stated rule now selects Complex.

Reason: The rule compares validation errors; it does not ban complex models.

Ask for evidence rather than a stronger claim

Before continuing, underline the decision rule and circle the **evidence** that supports the conclusion. Explain the example to a partner without replacing the counts or conditions with a stronger claim.

Keep the distinction between an observed result and a proposed next step.

Use the diagram and verbal explanation together. Ask learners to match a sentence to a specific visual step; do not assign learners fixed visual or auditory learning styles.

Cover the result. Ask learners to name the **input**s and predict the next step. Uncover one step, connect the icon to the actual procedure, and explain its **evidence**. Then change the supplied condition and compare.

The picture is a representation; it does not document execution of a real AI model.

▼ Earlier wording, alternatives and picture transcripts

Explain the mechanism

Input → **Process** → **Output**

Trace the information. At each stage, ask what changed and how you could test it.

Which stage could fail even when the other two are correct? Explain:

Predict first. Then check each step. A correct answer without visible reasoning is incomplete **evidence**.

1. Simple rule: difficulty ≤ reader level + 1.

2. Memorized rule: seven title-specific **exception**s.

3. Both fit the seen books; only new books reveal **generalization**.

4. Prefer the simplest rule that performs well on fair validation cases.

Recalculate, retrace, or restate the reasoning in your own representation:

CHECK Did the **evidence** answer the exact question? Did the total, path, or source record stay consistent?

Concrete teaching case

Rule A memorises six **training** book names. It scores 6/6 familiar and 2/6 new. Rule B uses relevant traits but is untested.

What does the **evidence** support?

Exact explanation to model

A shows weak transfer. B might generalise better but requires testing; simplicity is not proof.

Explain the added worked example

Key terms

Term	Meaning
Capacity	Flexibility of a model to represent patterns
Overfitting	Learning details that fail to generalize well
Underfitting	Failing to capture useful structure
Generalization	Performance on relevant unseen examples

Model the reasoning aloud

Use the complete worked example below before asking learners to complete W2. Reveal a small part, invite a **prediction**, then explain the deciding step.

These teacher notes contain solutions; do not reveal the independent case answer during modelling.

Overfitting and model capacity at a glance

PART	EVIDENCE OR ACTION	INTERPRETATION
Constant	Training 5	Validation 6
Line	Training 2	Validation 3
Flexible curve	Training 0	Validation 8

The curve result is consistent with overfitting, but a gap alone does not prove its cause. A changed population, bad labels or a split error could also produce a gap. Inspect the procedure before claiming a diagnosis. The constant may miss useful structure, but these numbers alone do not identify the true relationship.

Thinking move	Teacher prompt
Plan	What is given? What is the question? Which procedure fits these facts?
Do	Point to each input and intermediate step in the worked trace. Name the rule that allows the next step.
Check	Does the output answer the question? Which assumption or limitation prevents a larger claim?

A pictorial worked case: Overfitting Intuition

The facts we will use

AI ACADEMY / AI-2/16

Training and validation errors

	Training MAE pages	Validation MAE pages
Simple	5	6
Medium	2	3
Complex	0	7

Read a cell using both its row and column labels.

Follow the labelled picture with the matching explanation. Open the vector diagram

AI ACADEMY / AI-2/16

Overfitting Intuition

Start with the supplied facts

Follow each arrow. Ask which fact allows the next step.



1. Training comparison

Complex fits training perfectly with zero error.



2. Validation comparison

Medium has error 3, versus Simple 6 and Complex 7.



3. Choose for development

Select Medium under the declared lowest-validation-error rule.



4. Final evaluation

Freeze the selection, then evaluate new reserved cases.

CHANGE ONE THING

Complex's validation error becomes 2 on a newly documented, fair development comparison.

Explain the changed result using the matching lesson.

Follow the labelled picture with the matching explanation. Open the vector diagram

Read the picture one step at a time

STEP	WHAT HAPPENS AND WHY
1. Training comparison	Complex fits training perfectly with zero error.
2. Validation comparison	Medium has error 3, versus Simple 6 and Complex 7.
3. Choose for development	Select Medium under the declared lowest-validation-error rule.
4. Final evaluation	Freeze the selection, then evaluate new reserved cases.

Match each pictured step to the supplied facts. This is a worked teaching case, not an independent assessment.

Why this result follows

What this example does not establish

Change one thing in the pictured case

Ask while showing the picture

Guide the reasoning, then remove help

> Collect a response from each learner before discussing the worked key.

Prompt before revealing

Completion task: Does a **training**-validation gap alone prove **overfitting**?

Expected reasoning and fading help

Teacher check: Teacher explanation: No. It is consistent with **overfitting** but may also reflect shift, data quality or split problems.

Start by identifying the given **input**s together. Leave the intermediate steps blank. If needed, model one step, then withdraw that help on the next step. Move to a full trace only when the partial trace is understood.

For partners, alternate explainer and checker; collect a response from every learner before discussion.

Check the misconception before discussion

Use the worked case for **Overfitting** and model **capacity**. Proposed explanation: “A final answer is enough”. Decide whether this explanation is supported.

Point to the step or supplied fact that decides; explain your repair if needed.

Expected correction: Ask for the relevant counts, units, procedure or saved record. For this week: Choose the line with validation MAE 3. The curve **training** MAE 0 does not compensate for validation MAE 8.

Collect explanations, not only yes/no votes. If a misunderstanding is common, re-model the relevant step for the class.

If it affects a few learners, give a short targeted group explanation while others solve a more demanding variation.

Use the pictorial check

Does zero **training** error justify choosing Complex in the original record?

No. The declared criterion is validation error; Medium's 3 is lowest, while Complex's validation error is 7.

Changed-case reasoning: The stated rule now selects Complex. The rule compares validation errors; it does not ban complex models.

Collect each learner's explanation before discussion. Use the first missing connection between **input**, deciding step and result to choose support. This question is worked-case practice, not fresh mastery **evidence**.

Keep each learner explaining

- Ask: Which facts are given, and which would we have to assume? Learners mark relevant details before discussing answers.
- Say: Predict first. Show the rule, information path or calculation that would produce the result. A correct guess is not yet an explanation.
- In pairs, one learner solves while the other checks **evidence**; exchange roles. Remove the worked answer before independent assessment.

▼ Earlier wording, alternatives and picture transcripts

Demonstrate and guide practice

Board sequence

Write the given facts: Rule A memorises six **training** book names. It scores 6/6 familiar and 2/6 new. Rule B uses relevant traits but is untested.

Write the question to explain: What does the **evidence** support?

Reveal after **prediction**s: A shows weak transfer. B might generalise better but requires testing; simplicity is not proof.

Use the earlier changed question as optional later practice. Reserve Apply independently for the first independent attempt before hints or feedback.

Classroom dialogue

Reveal reasoning one step at a time. Explain why a tempting alternative fails. Write units and denominators for arithmetic, trace conditions for decisions, and identify supporting sources for claims.

Model these guided questions

Guided response: No. It is consistent with **overfitting** but may also reflect shift, data quality or split problems.

Exit response: Check data provenance, split grouping, label quality and repeated development results; inspect representative residuals without using final test feedback to tune.

Case-specific teaching sequence

Stage · Teacher action

> **Stage:** Session 1 start to 7 minutes
>
> **Teacher action:** Use the prerequisite question: Can a zero training error guarantee good validation performance? Check the explanation before proceeding.

> **Stage:** 7 to 18 minutes
>
> **Teacher action:** Read the opening and model the worked evidence. Ask students to identify capacity in context.

> **Stage:** 18 to 32 minutes
>
> **Teacher action:** Complete W 1 and W 2 with support: select from evidence; interpret a gap. Require the evidence, not only the final response.

> **Stage:** 32 to 45 minutes
>
> **Teacher action:** Read the visual row by row. Collect the guided explanation and compare reasoning in pairs. Connect each conclusion to the stated evidence.

> **Stage:** Session 2 start to 8 minutes

> **Teacher action:** Retrieve the distinction between capacity and overfitting. Invite a counterexample to an overconfident claim.

> **Stage:** 8 to 20 minutes
>
> **Teacher action:** Discuss the application and complete W 3: Describe one fair next development comparison.

> **Stage:** 20 to 35 minutes
>
> **Teacher action:** Collect W4 independently before giving hints. Assess these outcomes: Compare training and validation evidence for model capacity; Explain overfitting without assuming every gap proves it. Record any support used.

> **Stage:** 35 to 45 minutes
>
> **Teacher action:** Use W 5 and the exit response to assess limits. Give targeted feedback, then the fresh retry. Save evidence of independent understanding.

Reduce help deliberately

Individual reasoning check

Pictorial practice question

Reasoned teacher answer

MAIN LESSON · SECTION 4

Run the supplied investigation

> Keep expected results, observed paper traces and remaining limits distinguishable.

Supplied materials and answer guidance

Four-book audit: Constant absolute errors12,8,4,0 sum24/4=6pages; Line3,3,3,3 sum12/4=3; Flexible8,8,8,8 sum32/4=8. Choose Line under smallest validation MAE; training summaries are supplied rather than recomputed. Separate pictured comparison selects Medium3 versus6/7; a hypothetical Complex validation2 would change that selection. Do not merge those records or claim simpler always wins. Inspect data quality, grouping, shift and repeated development results before diagnosing memorised noise. Reserve A/B/C for independent W4.

Run and record

1. Predict → Test → Record → Explain
2. Keep expected and actual results separate. Surprises are useful data when recorded honestly.
3. Audit the supplied four-book validation predictions: retain each absolute error, sum and denominator, compare with the supplied **training** summaries and explain a controlled next step. No sealed-card dataset or real model fitting is supplied for this investigation.
4. What did the hardest test teach you that the normal test did not?

Keep an inspectable record

Record	What to capture
Input or evidence	Exact data, instruction or claim
Expected result	Answer or safe fallback declared before the run
Observed result	Actual result, including errors
Explanation	Rule, calculation or evidence explaining the outcome
Next test	One justified change and a new prediction

Diagnose the first misunderstanding

A final answer is enough: Ask for the relevant counts, units, procedure or saved record. For this week: Choose the line with validation MAE 3. The curve **training** MAE 0 does not compensate for validation MAE 8.

A stronger claim makes a stronger project: Check data provenance, split grouping, label quality and repeated development results; inspect representative residuals without using final test feedback to tune.

The new case can be copied from the example: The independent task changes the **evidence**. Require a fresh explanation: B wins the validation tie by the declared simplicity rule.

C is not selected merely for its zero **training** error.

Choose support from the response

What the response shows	Next teaching action
Missing or misread facts	Read the case aloud, mark supplied versus unknown facts, and let the learner restate it.
Wrong procedure	Return to the deciding step in the worked case. Contrast it with the proposed incorrect explanation.
Arithmetic or implementation error	Trace intermediate values or lines; preserve the first mismatch and retry that step.
Correct result without a reason	Ask for a trace and a changed case before marking independent understanding.
An unsupported wider claim	Ask which supplied evidence supports the claim and which further observation would be needed.

Offer an oral explanation, drawing, enlarged visual or fewer examples when that removes a reading/writing barrier. Keep the same reasoning goal.

Stretch secure learners by changing a boundary or assumption and asking them to defend the effect, not simply by assigning more of the same questions.

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<summary>Earlier wording, alternatives and picture transcripts</summary>

Run the weekly evidence lab

Words You Can Use to Reason

A definition matters when you can recognize the idea, use it, and contrast it with a near-miss.

Make the lab runnable

Use the supplied investigation for shared practice. Keep predictions and observed paper-trace results separate. Reserve Apply independently for the individual first attempt before feedback; do not use the reserved case as a paired lab task.

Diagnose and reteach

For guessing, return to given facts and request a trace. For vocabulary without application, use one example and one non-example. For arithmetic errors, check the setup before the calculation.

Finish with a different uncoached case before recording mastery.

Address these additional misconceptions

Match the support to the first error

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MAIN LESSON · SECTION 5

Assess the selected new case

> Keep this key until after the first attempt; accept valid alternatives with defensible reasoning.

Selected independent question and key

Selected case: Models A **training** 4 validation 5, B **training** 1 validation 2, C **training** 0 validation 2. Lowest validation MAE then simpler; B is simpler than C. Choose and justify.

Teacher explanation: B wins the validation tie by the declared simplicity rule. C is not selected merely for its zero **training** error.

Judge explanation, trace and limits

Dimension	Evidence required
Explanation	Names the applicable idea or procedure and ties it to the supplied facts.
Trace and result	Preserves the given inputs and shows the relevant intermediate steps; distinguishes a prediction from an observed execution.
Limits	States the assumptions, missing evidence or conditions under which the result would change.

Record each dimension as not yet, with support, or independent. Accept a valid alternative procedure with a defensible trace.

Do not penalise an honestly recorded model failure if the learner correctly explains its **evidence** and limits.

Give one usable repair action

Name the earliest unsupported step and give one action to repair it. Have the learner make that repair now and explain why. Then assess the relevant skill on a fresh, fully specified case.

Confirm it was not previously practised with feedback; solve and check the new case before assigning it. A follow-up design prompt is a starting brief, not automatically an equivalent test.

W1 Select from evidence

Choose among the three worked candidates and explain the **training** trap.

Teacher explanation: Choose the line with validation MAE 3. The curve **training** MAE 0 does not compensate for validation MAE 8.

W2 Interpret a gap

Does a **training**-validation gap alone prove **overfitting**?

Teacher explanation: No. It is consistent with **overfitting** but may also reflect shift, data quality or split problems.

W3 Propose a controlled change

Describe one fair next development comparison.

Teacher explanation: Compare a simpler curve against the current curve on the same validation rows, retaining the same metric and **training**-only **fitting**; log the change.

W5 Limit a diagnosis

What extra **evidence** would you inspect before concluding a model memorized noise?

Teacher explanation: Check data provenance, split grouping, label quality and repeated development results; inspect representative residuals without using final test feedback to tune.

▼ Earlier wording, alternatives and picture transcripts

Assess and explain the answers

Worked case answer

A shows weak transfer. B might generalise better but requires testing; simplicity is not proof.

Additional transfer practice question

Rule A memorises six **training** book IDs. Rule B uses a relevant topic feature. Why might A fail on a new ID? What test is needed?

Reasoned practice answer

A has no learned relationship for the new ID beyond memorised records. Test both on unseen books with correct labels; B's relevance is promising but does not guarantee success.

What counts as evidence

Criterion	0 points	1 point	2 points
Result	Incorrect or absent	Partly correct	Correct with necessary conditions
Reasoning	No supporting trace	Some steps	Clear mechanism, calculation or source support
Limit	Overclaims certainty	Vague limitation	Relevant uncertainty or missing fact
Transfer	Copies without adapting	Adapts with prompts	Solves a changed case independently

Use 6/8 as a classroom checkpoint, with 2 required for both Result and Reasoning. This is a proposed teaching rule, not a validated certification threshold.

Do not count a coached answer as independent mastery; correct unsafe or unsupported claims regardless of total.

Feedback

Ask the learner to find the **evidence** that challenges this claim: “Perfect **training** results guarantee unseen performance.” Keep the first attempt and an uncoached retry separate.

Original transfer answer

B has better validation performance and is the stronger candidate here. A's large gap suggests poor transfer.

Evaluate the selected rule on fresh final cases; neither simplicity nor one small validation set proves universal superiority.

Explanations for the additional workbook examples

W1 Select from evidence

W2 Interpret a gap

W3 Propose a controlled change

W4 Apply independently

Models A **training** 4 validation 5, B **training** 1 validation 2, C **training** 0 validation 2. Lowest validation MAE then simpler; B is simpler than C. Choose and justify.

Teacher explanation: B wins the validation tie by the declared simplicity rule. C is not selected merely for its zero **training** error.

W5 Limit a diagnosis

Assess independent transfer

Selected case answer

Feedback that the learner uses

MAIN LESSON · SECTION 6

Connect, adapt and return

> Retain the project evidence and revisit the reasoning on a changed case.

Project evidence to keep

Avoid title-by-title patches; improve features or thresholds that transfer.

Keep the decision, **input**, result, explanation and remaining limitation in the project **evidence** record. Retrieve this record next week rather than restarting the project.

Compare recommender revisions on fixed development cases, reserving new cases for the final presentation.

Support while preserving the reasoning goal

Trace one record or condition at a time with counters and labelled columns. Stretch: introduce a tie, boundary or missing field and declare its handling policy before rerunning.

Provide a blank **evidence** table and allow a verbal explanation before writing. Highlight the given conditions without supplying the W 4 conclusion. Use **capacity** and **overfitting** in full sentences.

Extension: alter one condition in the worked example and explain which conclusion changes and which remains supported.

For independent W 4, require: B wins the validation tie by the declared simplicity rule. C is not selected merely for its zero **training** error.

Fresh retry **training**/validation D 3/4 E 0/7 F 2/3: choose F under lowest validation loss. Explain why E is not automatically best. Mark each criterion as independent, supported or not yet demonstrated.

Reassess the reasoning after feedback; do not replace the first attempt silently.

Plan the delayed check

Suggested return points in this level: ai-2/17, ai-2/19, ai-2/22. Use actual classroom dates, adjusting for holidays and gaps. One, three and six teaching weeks are scheduling choices, not a claimed optimal spacing.

At a delayed check, ask for the idea from memory and a changed application. Compare with the earlier independent response and record support used.

For a new level, revisit the previous capstone before checking the new prerequisites.

Record	Teacher evidence
Learner code and date	
Concept and case used; prior exposure	
Explanation / trace / limits	
Support and first repair	
Changed case and delayed outcome	

Record	Teacher evidence
Next teaching action	

Use the **evidence** to choose reteaching or the next step. A completed page, confidence rating or attractive project does not by itself demonstrate understanding.

Bridge to next week

Ask for one decision the learner can now justify and one situation requiring more **evidence** or human review. Confidence ratings are separate from correct independent performance.

Next: Week 17: Noise and Outliers. Retrieve today's **evidence** and identify what carries forward and what is new.

Next is Week 17: Noise and Outliers. Carry forward the saved split, metric and comparison record; investigate unusual observations without assuming every large error is invalid data.

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<summary>Earlier wording, alternatives and picture transcripts</summary>

Connect and extend learning

Transparent Book Recommender

Support and stretch

Exit reflection

Bridge to the next week

Support and fresh reassessment

Plan the delayed return

Project evidence from this case
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Reference bank and extra practice

Choose the reference that helps your next step.

▼ **Reference: alternative planning checklist**

REFERENCE · SECTION 7

Reference: alternative planning checklist

> Use as a reminder alongside the main route rather than teaching the cycle twice.

Preparation and schedule

Teaching target: Compare **training** and validation **evidence** for model **capacity**

Prepare the labelled worked-case picture, the matching workbook, fictional **input** cards and a place for individual responses. No paid AI account is required for the paper reasoning activities.

Session · Plan · Resources

> **Session:** Session 1 · Understand · 45 min
>
> **Plan:** 0–7: recall and prerequisite; 7–15: inspect the concrete case and predict; 15–30: teacher models the worked trace; 30–40: learners explain a step using the text and visual; 40–45: check the core idea.
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> **Resources:** Use Run the investigation, Connect your project, Show what you know, Study a complete case and Try a new case independently. Allow extra time for the full task set. Use a coding lab only when this week actually provides one; Your lesson route is the planning section.

Practice and assessment reminders

Before class, solve the supported practice: Does a **training**-validation gap alone prove **overfitting**?

Reasoned practice answer: Teacher explanation: No. It is consistent with **overfitting** but may also reflect shift, data quality or split problems.

Check every learner before discussion: Use the worked case for **Overfitting** and model **capacity**. Proposed explanation: “A final answer is enough”. Decide whether this explanation is supported.

Point to the step or supplied fact that decides; explain your repair if needed.

Misconception repair: Ask for the relevant counts, units, procedure or saved record. For this week: Choose the line with validation MAE 3. The curve **training** MAE 0 does not compensate for validation MAE 8.

Support: read the exact case aloud, enlarge the labelled picture, supply **input** cards and model only the first deciding step. Accept a spoken explanation or drawing; retain the reasoning goal.

Extension: Complex’s validation error becomes 2 on a newly documented, fair development comparison. Require a **prediction** and a reason before comparing. Expected result: The stated rule now selects Complex.

Reason: The rule compares validation errors; it does not ban complex models.

Independent assessment: withhold the reserved answer until the learner has attempted the new case. Record support separately from correctness.

Criterion	Not yet	With support	Independent
Explanation	Names an answer without a deciding fact	Uses a hint to link fact and decision	Explains the deciding fact in own words
Trace or test	Cannot connect input and result	Completes steps with prompts	Traces or tests a changed case accurately
Limits and revision	Claims more than evidence supports	Names a limit after a prompt	States a defensible limit and useful next test

Project checkpoint: Test changed cases. Keep normal, boundary and failure cases; compare expected and observed results.

Use the weekly teacher answer for topic-specific reasoning. A saved progress tick is an activity record; judge mastery from the learner's explanation and **evidence**.

▼ **Reference: feedback and records**

REFERENCE · SECTION 8

Reference: feedback and records

> Use digital tools where they help retain an explanation and its evidence.

Keep practice and independent evidence separate

Use the two formative questions as supported practice, not as independent mastery scores. Discuss the deciding **evidence** rather than accepting a guessed selection.

The feedback comes from the reviewed public worked case. Do not reveal the separately reserved independent teacher answer until the learner has attempted that case.

Repair and portfolio records

Use the earlier worked-explanation links to address a specific missing building block, then return to the current question. Adapt this suggestion after observing the learner; it is not an automatic diagnosis.

Collect the completed-work portfolio as **evidence**. Record support separately from correctness, and assess explanation, trace/test and limitations. Progress ticks and quiz selections alone do not establish mastery.

<details>
<summary>Earlier wording, alternatives and picture transcripts</summary>

This week has no code block. Use this routine when a later lesson includes an executable lab.

Ask students to predict before running code. Preserve errors and actual **output**s; collect a changed test and an explanation. The branch-boundary and indexing lessons deliberately include failure cases.
</details>

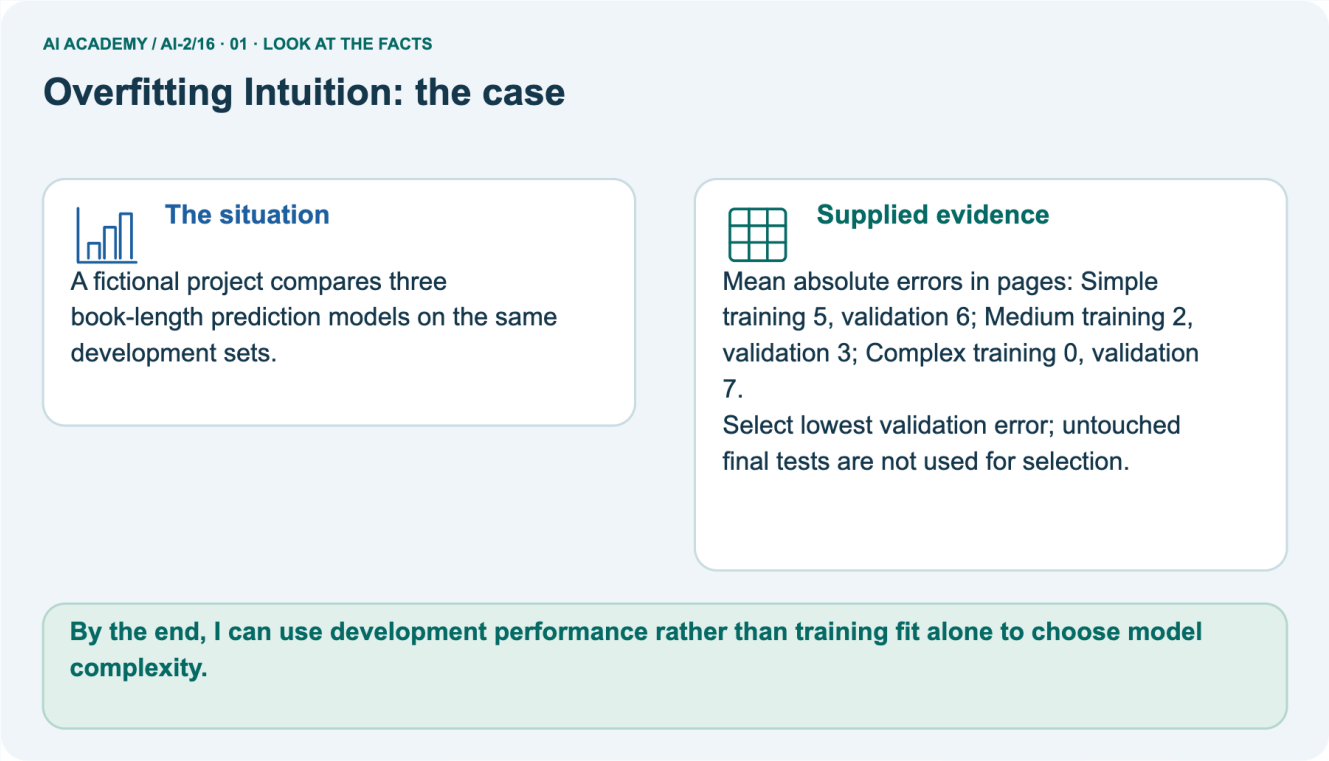
<details>
<summary>Reference: teach with the six pictures</summary>
</details>

REFERENCE · SECTION 9

Reference: teach with the six pictures

> Choose the picture for the teaching move and connect it to the explanation.

01. Overfitting Intuition: the case



Follow the labelled picture with the matching explanation. Open the vector diagram

A fictional project compares three book-length **prediction** models on the same development sets.

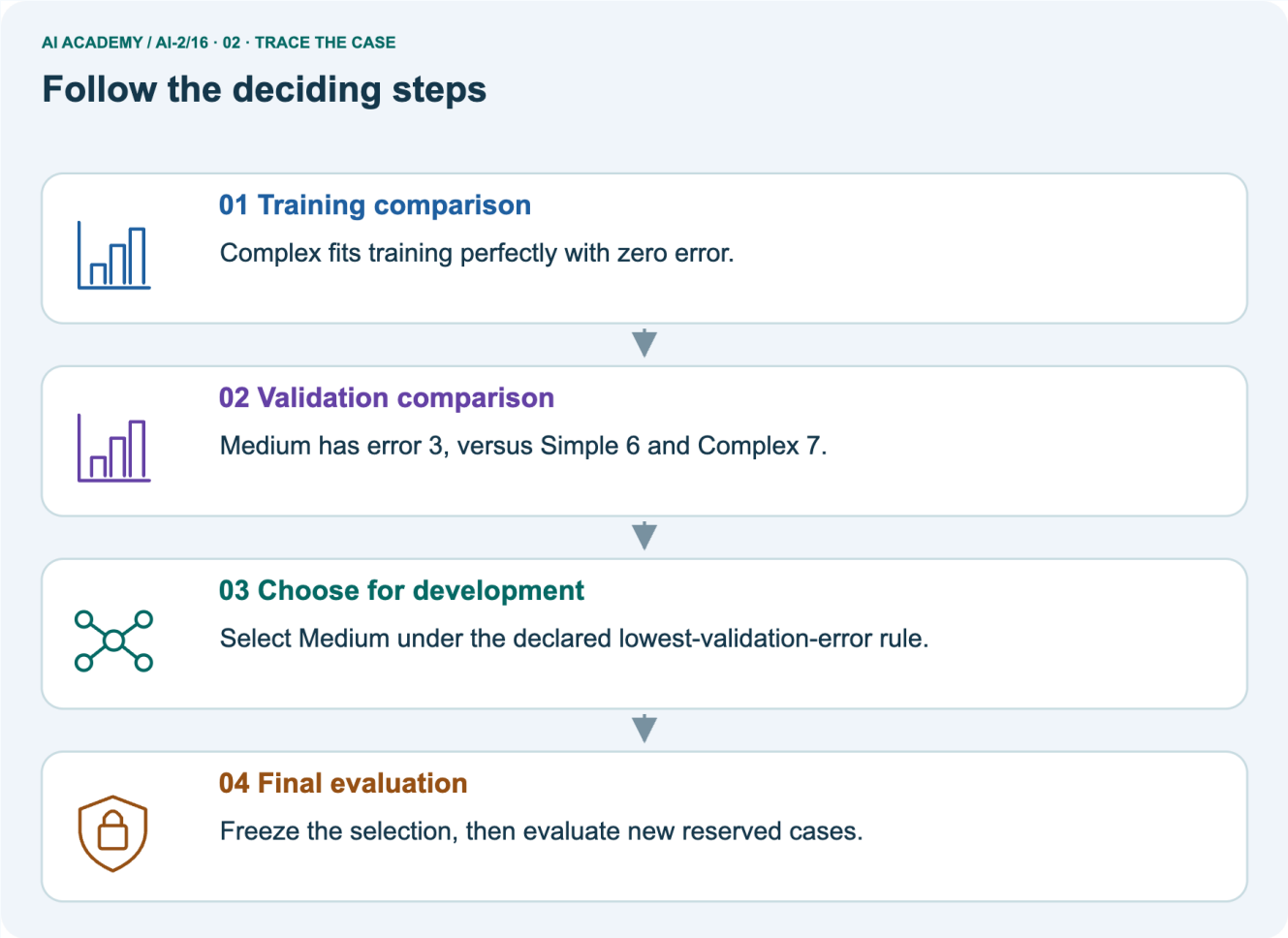
Supplied facts: Mean absolute errors in pages: Simple **training** 5, validation 6; Medium **training** 2, validation 3; Complex **training** 0, validation 7.

Select lowest validation error; untouched final tests are not used for selection.

Point to the given fact that matters most. Explain why it matters.

Teacher prompt: Point to the given fact that matters most. Explain why it matters. Ask learners to describe one label or arrow in ordinary words. Use the adjacent transcript if the image is difficult to see.

02. Follow the deciding steps



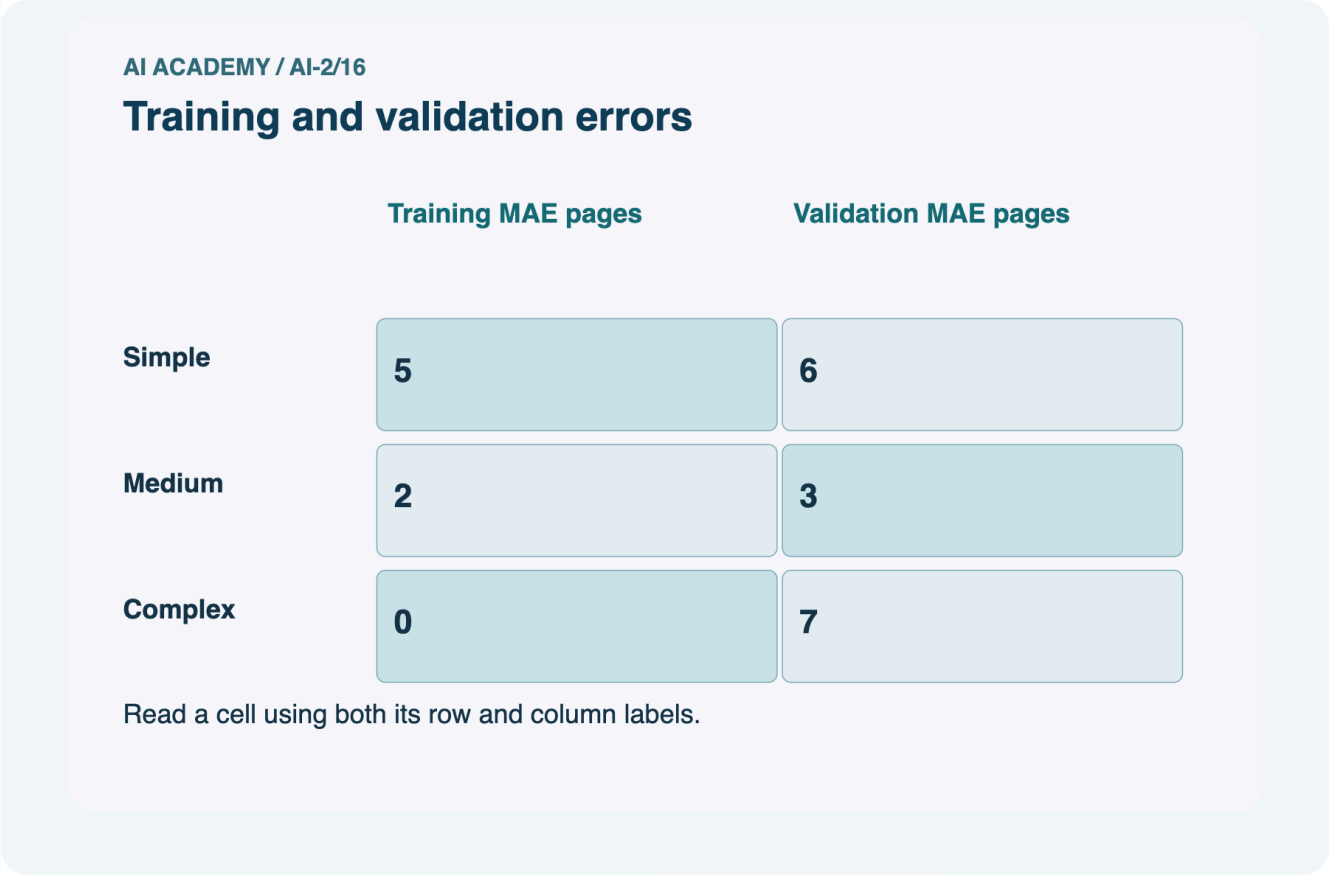
Follow the labelled picture with the matching explanation. Open the vector diagram

Training comparison: Complex fits **training** perfectly with zero error. → Validation comparison: Medium has error 3, versus Simple 6 and Complex 7. → Choose for development: Select Medium under the declared lowest-validation-error rule. → Final evaluation: Freeze the selection, then evaluate new reserved cases.

Point to each numbered stage and explain which recorded **input** it uses.

Teacher prompt: Point to each numbered stage and explain which recorded **input** it uses. Ask learners to describe one label or arrow in ordinary words. Use the adjacent transcript if the image is difficult to see.

03. Training and validation errors



Follow the labelled picture with the matching explanation. Open the vector diagram

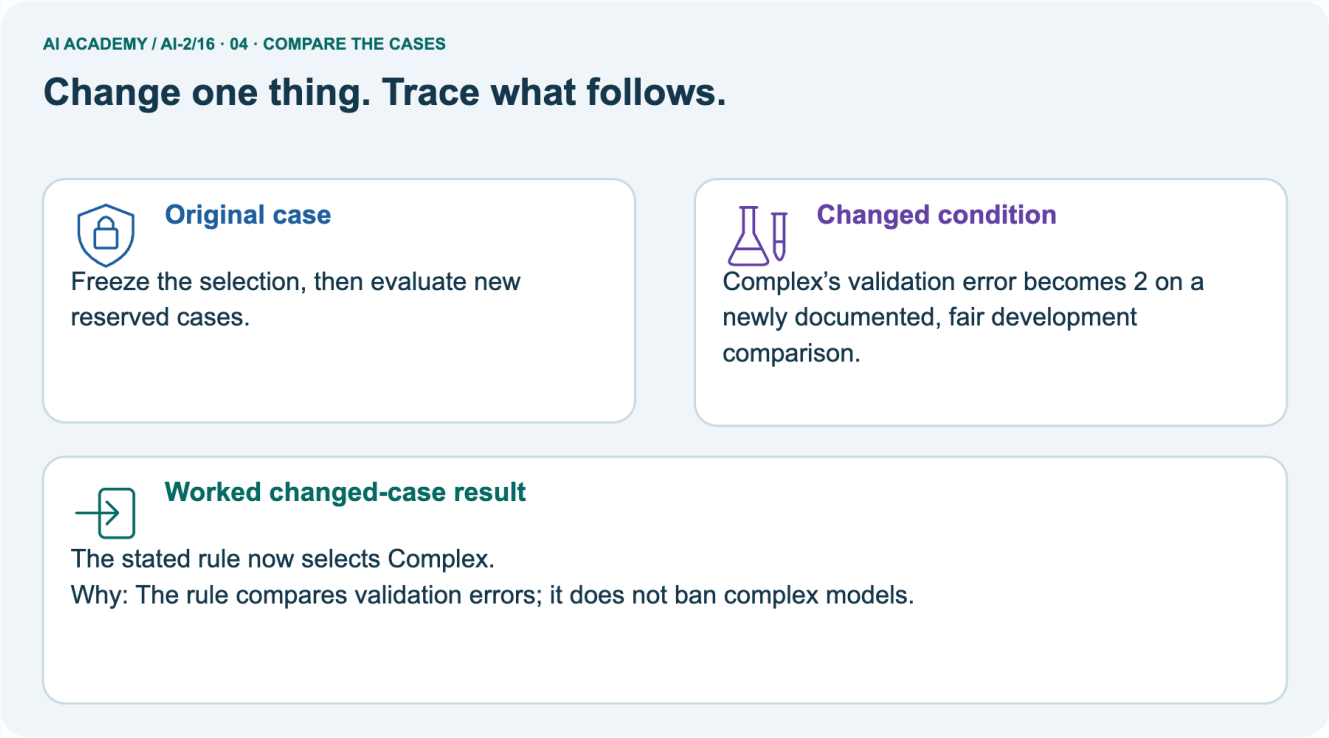
Training and validation errors. Simple: **Training** MAE pages = 5, Validation MAE pages = 6. Medium: **Training** MAE pages = 2, Validation MAE pages = 3. Complex: **Training** MAE pages = 0, Validation MAE pages = 7.

Read the labels and values. Explain the relationship the model shows.

Teacher prompt: Read the labels and values. Explain the relationship the model shows. Ask learners to describe one label or arrow in ordinary words. Use the adjacent transcript if the image is difficult to see.

Check row/column meanings, units and denominators before discussing a difference. Supplied toy values are not real class or model results.

04. Change one thing. Trace what follows.



Follow the labelled picture with the matching explanation. Open the vector diagram

Original case: Freeze the selection, then evaluate new reserved cases. Changed condition: Complex's validation error becomes 2 on a newly documented, fair development comparison.

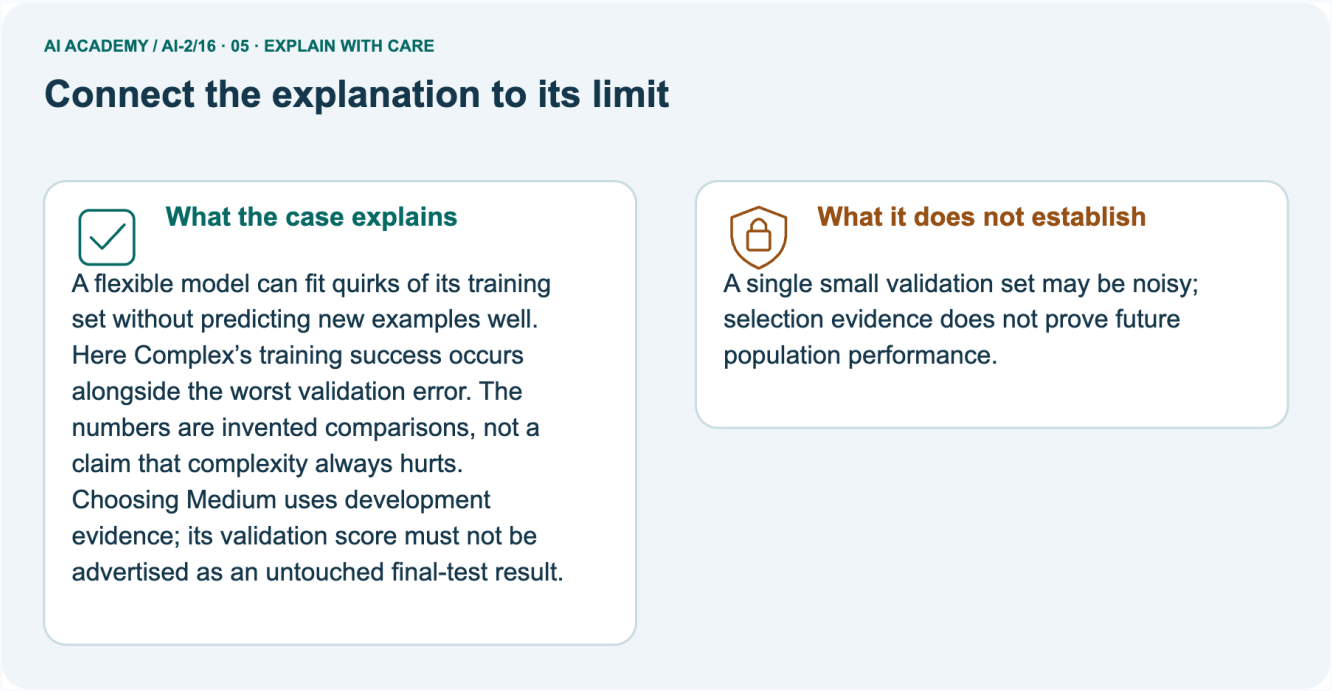
Expected result: The stated rule now selects Complex. Reason: The rule compares validation errors; it does not ban complex models.

Predict before checking the worked changed-case result. Name what changed and what the supplied facts allow you to conclude.

Teacher prompt: Predict before checking the worked changed-case result. Name what changed and what the supplied facts allow you to conclude. Ask learners to describe one label or arrow in ordinary words.

Use the adjacent transcript if the image is difficult to see. Changed-case reasoning: The rule compares validation errors; it does not ban complex models.

05. Connect the explanation to its limit



Follow the labelled picture with the matching explanation. Open the vector diagram

A flexible model can fit quirks of its **training** set without predicting new examples well. Here Complex's **training** success occurs alongside the worst validation error.

The numbers are invented comparisons, not a claim that **complexity** always hurts. Choosing Medium uses development **evidence**; its validation score must not be advertised as an untouched final-test result.

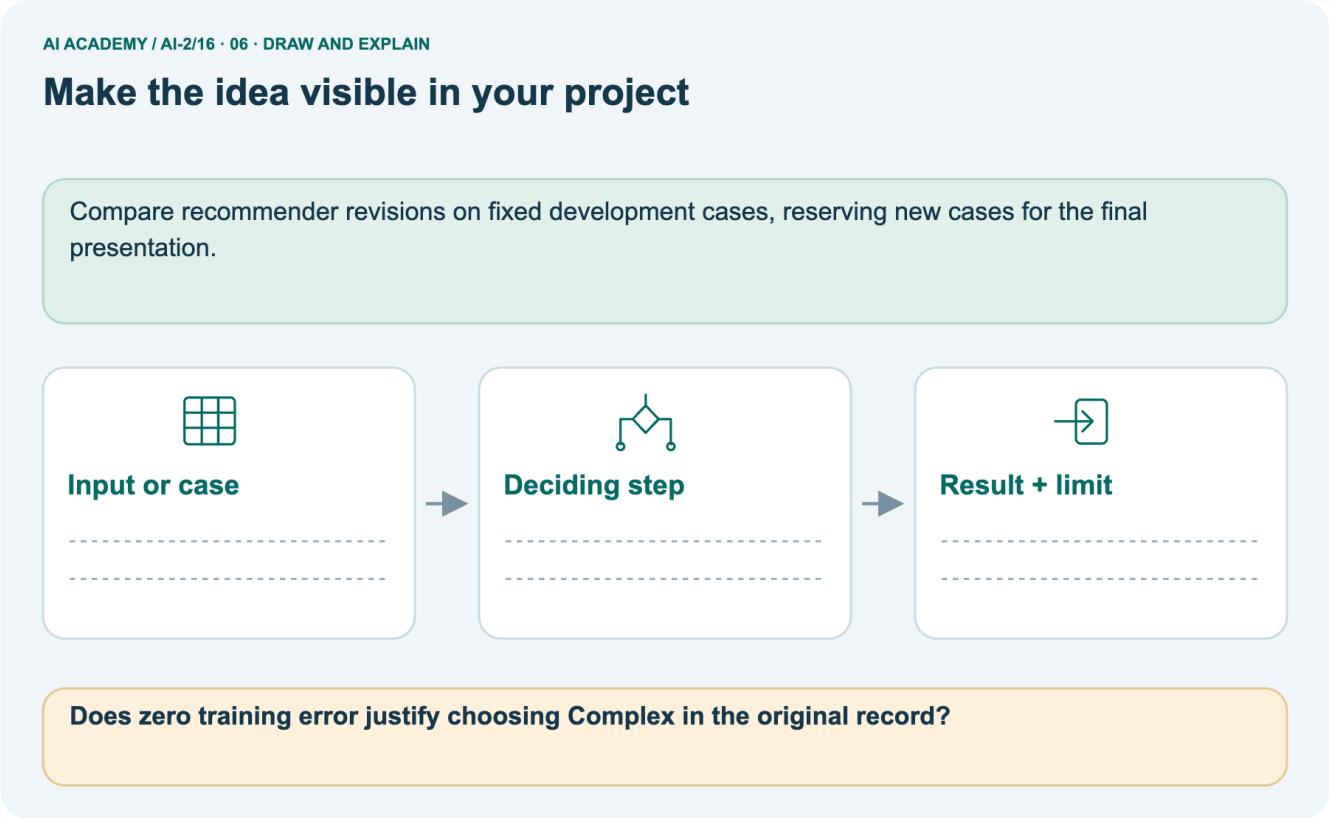
Limit: A single small validation set may be noisy; selection **evidence** does not prove future population performance.

Explain the case, then point to a limit on the claim.

Teacher prompt: Explain the case, then point to a limit on the claim. Ask learners to describe one label or arrow in ordinary words. Use the adjacent transcript if the image is difficult to see.

Keep the stated scope: A single small validation set may be noisy; selection **evidence** does not prove future population performance.

06. Make the idea visible in your project



Follow the labelled picture with the matching explanation. Open the vector diagram

Compare recommender revisions on fixed development cases, reserving new cases for the final presentation. Draw your **input**, deciding step, result and limit.

Supported question: Does zero **training** error justify choosing Complex in the original record?

Draw your project trace and justify the deciding step using **evidence**.

Teacher prompt: Draw your project trace and justify the deciding step using **evidence**. Ask learners to describe one label or arrow in ordinary words. Use the adjacent transcript if the image is difficult to see.

Supported practice key: No. The declared criterion is validation error; Medium's 3 is lowest, while Complex's validation error is 7.

▼ Earlier wording, alternatives and picture transcripts

Use one picture at a time. Hide a worked result before asking for a **prediction**, then reveal it for feedback. These are supported teaching cases; retain the separate independent assessment for a fresh first attempt.

01. Overfitting Intuition: the case

02. Follow the deciding steps

03. Training and validation errors

04. Change one thing. Trace what follows.

05. Connect the explanation to its limit

06. Make the idea visible in your project

▼ Optional interactive practice and completed work

Save or print your responses for your portfolio. Progress and drafts on the hosted website stay in the current browser. Use only fictional or teacher-approved data.